

Adding Sound To A Document

At times you may feel the need to add multimedia to your document and it is possible to add sound files to the document; here's how.

1. Position your cursor at the point where you want to insert a sound file.
2. Go to the Insert Tab of the Ribbon and click Object in the Text group. This will open the Object dialog box.
3. Browse and select the sound file to be inserted and click OK. A Speaker icon will appear at the insertion point.
4. To listen to the sound, double-click the speaker icon.

FIREFOX 3

Know Where You're Going

You can set Firefox to tell you when the site you're viewing redirects to another site—sometimes you may end up far from where you want to be. To enable this, go to Tools > Options (or Edit > Preferences if you're using Linux) > Advanced. Under General, check the box against Warn me when sites try to redirect or reload the page. Henceforth, you'll get a warning bar every time a site redirects you.

Create Your Own Smart Bookmarks

Firefox keeps a record of sites you visit often, and generates a list of "Smart Bookmarks" that you can access from the Bookmarks toolbar. You can create your own list of smart bookmarks using custom queries instead of URLs as well. Right-click on the Bookmarks toolbar and choose New Bookmark. Use a descriptive name for the bookmark, and under Location, enter one of the queries below (whichever suits your fancy, or tweak them to get the results you want):

●For your 10 Most Visited Sites:

```
place:queryType=0&sort=8
&maxResults=10
```

●For your 10 Most Recent Bookmarks:

```
place:queryType=1&sort=12
&maxResults=10
```

●For your 10 Most Visited Sites with "thinkdigit" in them:

```
place:queryType=0&sort=8
&maxResults=10&terms=thinkdigit
```

Here's all the information you need to build these queries:

sort options

0—Natural bookmark order

1—Sort by title, A-Z

2—Sort by title, Z-A

3—Sort by visit date, most recent last

4—Sort by visit date, most recent first

5—Sort by URI, A-Z

6—Sort by URI, Z-A

7—Sort by visit count, ascending

8—Sort by visit count, descending

9—Sort by keyword, A-Z

10—Sort by keyword, Z-A

11—Sort by date added, most recent last

12—Sort by date added, most recent first

13—Sort by last modified date, most recent last

14—Sort by last modified date, most recent first

17—Sort by tags, ascending

18—Sort by tags, descending

19—Sort by annotation, ascending

20—Sort by annotation, descending

queryType options

0—Search only History

1—Search only Bookmarks

2—Search both

maxResults is the maximum number of results you want.

Tag Your Bookmarks

While we're on the subject of bookmarks, you should also know that when you create a new bookmark, you now have the option to tag it—you could tag bookmarks relating to your upcoming holiday with "Monsoon Trip", for example. Make sure you separate each tag with a comma. Now, when you type a tag into Firefox's address bar, the bookmarks with that tag will come at the top of the list.

Find Faster

Instead of using [Ctrl] + [F] to find a word in a page, you can use Firefox 3's new Quick Find to search within a page—just hit [/] to begin. You can also eliminate this step by enabling Type Ahead Find. To enable it, type `about:config` in the address bar, and in the configuration page, look for `accessibility.typeaheadfind`. Double-click on it to set it to True. Now, to search for a word in a page, just start typing it, and quick find will find it for you. If you only want to look for links, also enable `accessibility.typeaheadfind.linkonly` (if you prefer using a shortcut instead of this, hit ['] to start Quick Finding links). When Quick Find has found your link, just hit [Enter] to visit it.

Richer Results?

When you begin typing in Firefox's address bar, the results are a lot smarter than just a list of previously visited sites. To increase the number of these smart (or rich, as they're called) results, open `about:config` in a new tab, and use the filter to search for `browser.urlbar.maxRichResults` double-click on it to change the value to anything you want.

Delete Meaningless Results

If you've mistyped a URL and visited it, Firefox will still bring it up in your rich results—clearly, you don't want that happening. To get rid of the entry, enter the URL till you see the one you don't want, use the down arrow to select it and hit [Delete] (on the Mac, you'll need to use [Shift] + [Delete]). You'll never see that URL in your rich results again.

Ring In The Old

If you don't like Firefox's rich results (displayed in what is actually called the AwesomeBar), you can use the Oldbar extension (<https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/addon/6227>) to get back to the old "URLs only" address bar.



Get the old Firefox address bar back

Gmail For mailto: Links

The ability to assign *protocol handlers* programs that'll accept links from different protocols like ftp, mailto and so on—isn't new, but thanks to Google's love for Firefox, you can now assign Gmail as the default e-mail handler for mailto: links. Open Gmail in a new tab. In this same tab, enter this JavaScript snippet: `javascript:window.navigator.registerProtocolHandler("mailto", "https://mail.google.com/mail/?extsrc=mailto&url=%s", "Gmail")`. You'll see a warning bar at the top of the page, asking you whether you want to add Gmail as the default mailto handler. Select Add Application, and you're done!



Time Lapse Photography

A quick, straightforward method to get time lapse photography

There are many tricks and experiments that can be done with digital cameras, and time lapse is one of them. Time lapse photography is great fun—capturing a time frame using single photos taken at intervals. All these frames are put together to create a short video clip. You don't need any high-end equipment to do this either—just a digital camera and a few free applications here and there. You also need patience and you need to be specific.

The Requirements

Getting to the specifics, you require a digital camera for capturing the images. You also need a tripod preferably, or a good stationary platform where you can keep your camera for a very long period. You need to download the latest version of VirtualDub (www.virtualdub.org). We'll be using it to encode the final video. You'll also need suitable codecs such as Xvid or x264 installed on your PC. If you wish to give your photos a slightly different treatment, then an image editor such as GIMP or even Photoshop will add sparkle to it.

I'm Equipped...Now What?

First select a target object you want to take the time lapse photo shoot of. It could be anything—a busy street, a blooming flower or even a lunar eclipse. Place the camera on the tripod or on a table at a suitable distance from the target you are shooting. Be extremely careful—you must not move the camera from that position at all. Remember that the camera has to be in that position for a really long period, so you shouldn't be doing a shoot like this on a rainy day.

Setting An Interval

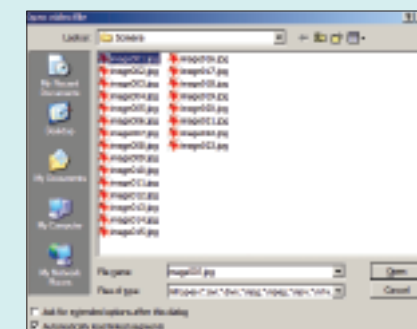
Depending on the type of object of the time lapse shoot, you need to decide an interval, after which the followings shots will be taken. A time lapse of a flower blooming in the morning could happen in 5 hours, for example, so you need a sufficient number of frames to make up a good length time lapse. For a good five second time lapse shot, you

would need a good 125 to 150 separate photos if you want a video with a frame rate of 30 fps. In this case, you would need to take a photo every 2 minutes of the object.

Once that is decided, turn on the camera's image stabilisation feature and use a two-second timer to prevent any shake that might occur with you press the trigger. Now it's just a matter of time and patience and clicking the photos in time after every two minutes. Make sure you have a sufficiently large memory card and the battery fully charged so you don't have to disturb the camera anytime. Remember, you don't need to take photos at 8 MP resolutions. Anything up to 3 MP should be good enough—the final result is going to be a video, not a slideshow. Don't change any settings between photos.

Creating The Time lapse Itself

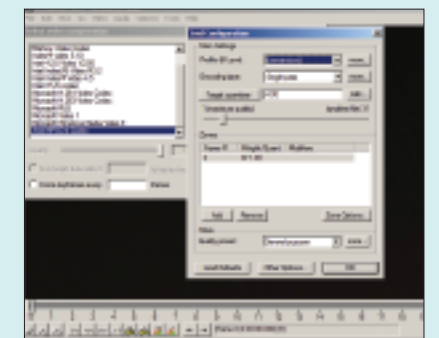
Once the shoot is done, copy all the images from the camera to a single folder on the computer. Make sure to delete all previous photos taken on the camera. At this point, you can use Photoshop to adjust or fix any photos that might have shifted.



Importing the entire sequence of images into VirtualDub

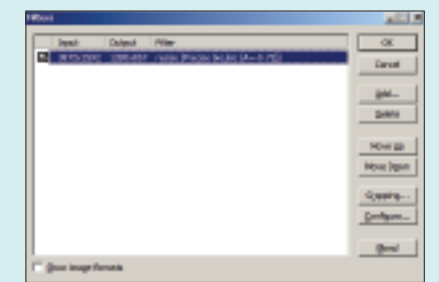
From here on, things get really simple. Open VirtualDub up and click on File > Open Video File. Make sure the checkbox for Automatically load linked segments is checked. Browse to the folder where the photos are stored and choose the first image of the sequence. Click on Open. Just be sure that the images are numbered properly.

Creating The Video



Selecting audio and video codecs for the movie

With the sequence video imported into VirtualDub, it's time to select the codec we want to use to export the video. Click on Video > Compression and then select a codec from the list. If you have Xvid, select it and choose the quality or bitrates at which you want the video encoded. If you want a short audio clip, you can add it by clicking on the Audio menu and then on Audio from other file. Select the file and click Open. You can also add some basic effects in VirtualDub by clicking Video > Filters. When you are happy with the clip, click on File > Save as AVI. Choose a location and click on Save.



Filters and effects can be added to enhance the video

A quick search for the keywords 'time lapse' in YouTube will show up several examples of people trying it with their own digital camera. Along with some very interesting time lapse sequences, you'll be shocked to find time lapse videos with people who have been taking photos of themselves everyday over a couple of years.

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